

DISTRICT SPECIAL · CHUSEOK D-9

Only Eulji-ro went up

01 Six districts, 20 months

Seongsu -21%, Dosan -33%, Sindang -31%, Eulji-ro +18%

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The final order calendar before the break

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'Gift' entered the whisky keywords for the first time. The peak is this week.

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Yajang opened as forecast

Last issue said the second week of September. It is up 71% off the low.

+18%

Eulji-ro liquor mentions
adjusted change (Jan–Aug)

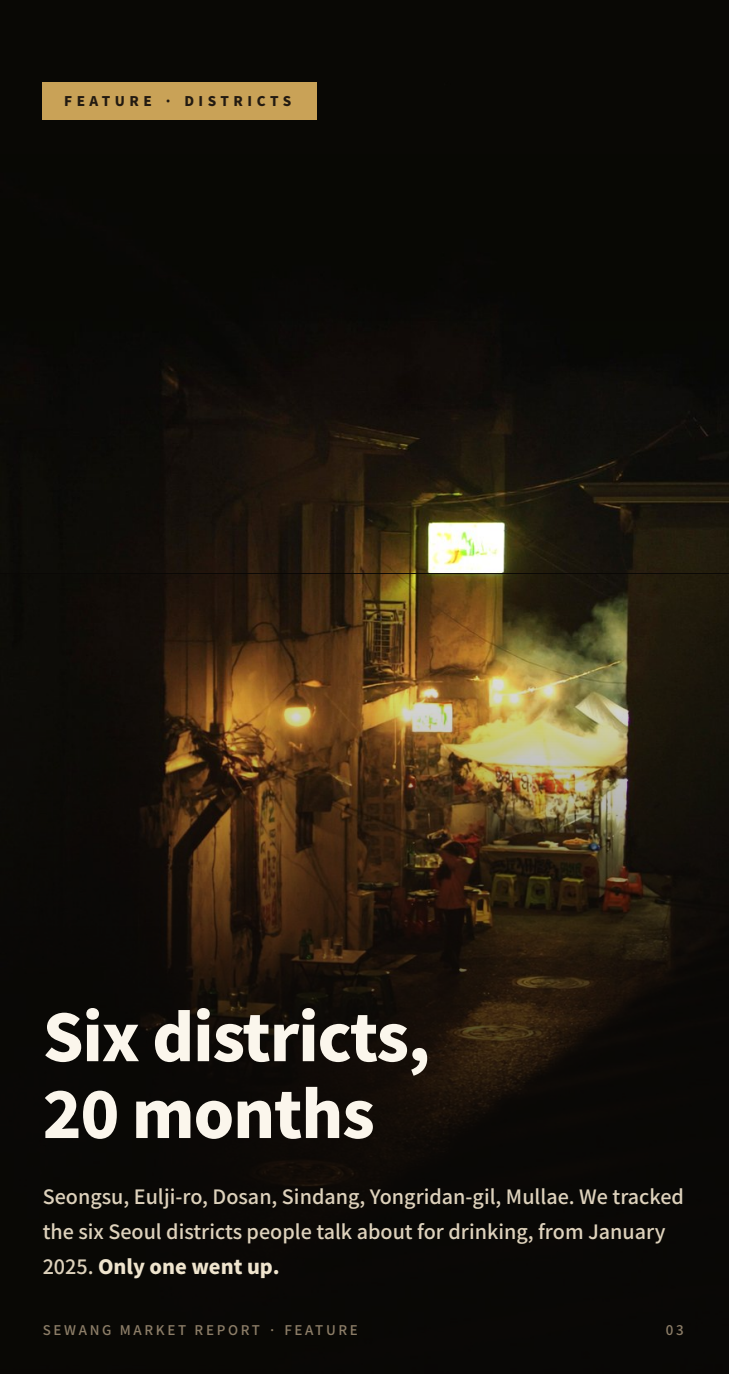
41%

Eulji-ro share of the
six districts measured

–33%

Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo
steepest fall

Editor's note — Read two months of a district and you will call a fall a rise. We did exactly that last month. **Over 20 months the answer was the opposite.**



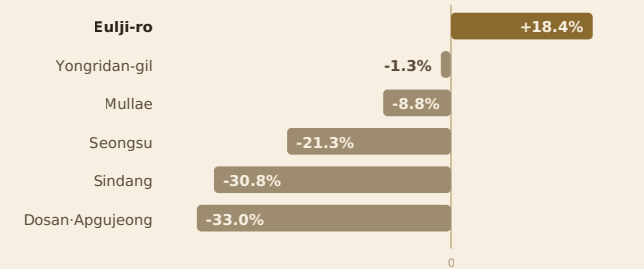
Six districts, 20 months

Seongsu, Eulji-ro, Dosan, Sindang, Yonggridan-gil, Mullae. We tracked the six Seoul districts people talk about for drinking, from January 2025. **Only one went up.**

Only one went up

Monthly counts of each district name appearing with drinking on Instagram, adjusted by ‘beer’ mentions (−4.5%).

JAN-AUG CHANGE · ADJUSTED BY BEER MENTIONS (%)



Five of the six fell. Only Eulji-ro rose, and it leads **on volume** too — 8,686 posts to August against Seongsu’s 4,490.

District	2025 share	2026 share
Eulji-ro	31.7%	41.0%
Seongsu-dong · Seongsu Stn.	24.6%	21.2%
Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo	14.7%	10.7%
Yongridan-gil · Sinyongsan	9.7%	10.5%
Sindang · Yaksu	10.9%	8.3%
Mullae	8.4%	8.4%

IN ONE LINE

Four in ten mentions across the six districts we measured are Eulji-ro’s. In one year, 9.3pp moved to one district.

Source: Sometrend Instagram monthly trend (2025.1–2026.8; Sep excluded as incomplete). District name + drinking terms.

Why Eulji-ro

We pulled the top 100 words that appear when Eulji-ro is named alongside drinking. The answer was not ‘hip’ alone.

ALLEYS

Hipjiro 677

Jongno 458

Chungmuro 228

Alley 155

OUTDOOR SEATS

Terrace 231

Show 220

Live 218

Rooftop 172

OLD-SHOP FOOD

Broth 310

Whelk 245

Squid 189

Chicken 186

The three clusters point one way: **alleys + outdoor seats + old-shop food**. That is exactly the yajang condition we covered last issue. Eulji-ro always had its beer alleys and street benches, and of the six districts we measured, only the one with that axis grew.

The list also carries **company dinner 204** and **new opening 179** — a sign that group bookings and new-venue enquiries are still live here. Frequency alone does not settle scale.

FOR OPERATORS

① Decide first whether your axis is ‘polished’ or ‘alley’ — the one growing is the alley. ② Outdoor seats + beer and soju + a broth dish is the surest demand; premium sits on top. ③ Late September into October overlaps dinner season — expect more group bookings.

Source: Sometrend Instagram top-100 associated keywords (Eulji-ro, 2026.7.1–9.11)

6 DAYS

Chuseok D-9: six days left

Chuseok falls on Friday 25 September; the break runs four days, Thursday the 24th to Sunday the 27th. The last delivery before it is **Wednesday 23 September — six trading days from the day this report goes out.**

Date	What to do
Wed 9/16 · today	Fix holiday volumes · split out chilled items
Thu 9/17–Fri 9/18	Recommended first order cutoff
Sat 9/19–Sun 9/20	Last weekend before the break · measure turnover
Mon 9/21	Final order cutoff
Tue 9/22	Delivery prep
Wed 9/23	Last delivery before the break
9/24–9/27	Distribution closed · on-call cover
Mon 9/28	Deliveries resume · dinner week

SPLIT THE ORDER IN TWO

What sells before the break (9/19–23) is not what sells after (9/28–10/2). Before is gifts and greetings; after is company dinners. **Take the 9/23 load and the 9/28 load separately rather than in one go** — it cuts waste. Draft kegs in particular stop turning over the four closed days.

Delivery dates around the October Foundation Day and Hangul Day holidays will be confirmed individually by your sales manager.



The switch flipped

Twice it was not there. **On the third reading it lit up.**

Chuseok gifting has ignited

Since mid-August we have measured whisky keywords across three two-week windows. In the first two, **‘gift’ was not in the top 100** — hence two issues saying it had not caught.

In the third window (29 Aug–11 Sep) **‘gift’ entered the top 100**. Naver Blog gifting posts agree — counted weekly and **aligned by days remaining to Chuseok**.

To Chuseok	2025	2026	Change
D-47	297	420	+41%
D-40	473	616	+30%
D-33	1,029	1,176	+14%
D-26	1,516	2,126	+40%
D-19	2,015	2,417	+20%

THE PEAK IS THIS WEEK

Last year’s curve **peaked at D-8** (2,855 posts). This year D-8 is **17 September** — the day after this report goes out. We are mid-climb, and the peak lands inside this week.

Whisky attaches to ‘gift’ about two weeks out. Searching begins a month out, but **the shelf only moves in the final two weeks**. So fix **three price tiers** (50,000 / 100,000 / 200,000 won) now, and build October for the **company dinners** that follow the break.

Source: Sometrend Instagram associated keywords (whisky, 2026.8.29–9.11) / Naver Blog weekly trend (liquor-gift terms, 2025.8–2026.9)

Three questions: axis • order • gifts

Q1 YOUR AXIS

What grew this year is not ‘polished’ but ‘alley’ — outdoor seats, broth dishes, beer and soju. Which side is your menu on?

Q2 DID YOU SPLIT THE ORDER

The last delivery on Wed 9/23 and the restart on Mon 9/28 sell different things. Before the break, gifts; after, company dinners. Did you take it all in one go?

Q3 READY FOR GIFT ENQUIRIES

We are mid-peak and the window is two weeks. Three price tiers fixed in advance turn an enquiry straight into a sale.

Item	9/16-9/23	9/28-Oct
Beer • soju	Increase	Increase
Draft beer kegs	Split around break	Increase
Whisky • gift sets	Increase	Reduce
Sake • cheongju	Hold	Increase
Broth-dish stock	Hold	Increase

Your sales manager will propose a mix sized to your venue and district.

+71%

Yajang opened as forecast

Last issue we wrote that the yajang season opens **from the second week of September**, because that is what last year's curve did.

Measured, yajang mentions rose from the summer low (703 in the first week of August) to **1,205 in the first week of September, up 71%**. The direction is as forecast — though the climb had already begun in mid-August.

One honest caveat. The last two weeks are still incomplete on the platform, so **the confirmed share-versus-beer figure returns next issue**. On absolute mentions alone the direction is clear.

WEEKS REMAINING

The Golden Zone runs **to the last week of October**. Counting this week, that is **seven weeks**, with six still to go. The lines that turn on outdoor seats — draft kegs, bottled beer, soju — stay raised throughout. The turn is the first week of November.

Source: Sometrend Instagram weekly trend (2026.6.22–9.11)

NEXT ISSUE

The last issue before the Chuseok break. Emergency stock cover during the holiday, plus a checklist for the dinner demand of the first week back (9/28–10/2).

A partner that grows alongside you

From Chuseok volumes to the dinner week after the break and urgent stock during it, your sales manager will advise you. Founded in 1978, Sewang Trading has served Seoul and Gyeonggi for nearly half a century.

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Gangnam Yeoksam · Nonhyeon · Sinsa · Cheongdam / Seongdong · Gwangjin	
Park Jung-eon Exec. Dir.	010-3286-9489
Gangnam Daechi · Samseong / Seocho · Bangbae / Gwanak · Dongjak	
Son Seung-il Man. Dir.	010-7539-3535
Franchise accounts	
Lee Won-cheol Director	010-3354-2101
Gangbuk · Jongno · Jung-gu / Dongdaemun · Jungnang · Nowon · Dobong	
Chae Hyun-yong Director	010-8889-3057
Hotels · wine	
Kim Hwan Director	010-4789-3282
Incheon / Bucheon · Siheung · Ansan	
Oh Gun-hoon Director	010-3495-6515
Songpa · Gangdong · Jamsil / Japanese liquor	
Shin Hong-cheol Director	010-9259-6474
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New account development	

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